

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Middle School | Unit 3

Suffix -ive



Today I am learning that the suffix **-ive** often forms an adjective that describes a **quality, tendency or relationship**.

1 Learn the Meaning

The suffix **-ive** commonly forms **adjectives**. These words can describe a quality, a tendency to do something, or a relationship to an action or idea.

active

showing action or movement

creative

able to create new ideas

protective

designed to protect

inventive

good at inventing ideas

2 Build the Word

Add **-ive** to the base or related word. Notice when the base spelling changes before the suffix is added.

Base word	Suffix	New word	What it describes
act	-ive	_____	_____
create	-ive	_____	_____
protect	-ive	_____	_____
invent	-ive	_____	_____
select	-ive	_____	_____

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

During a design challenge, the class had to create an **effective** solution for keeping a small container of water cool in the sun. Maya suggested an **inventive** cover made from layers of reused material, while Leon proposed a **protective** outer shell that could block heat and prevent damage. The group stayed **active** as they measured, tested and compared each idea. Their teacher encouraged **creative** thinking, but also reminded them to be **selective** about which materials they used. Some materials looked impressive but were not very **effective** insulators. After several trials, the students produced a more **responsive** design: it reacted well to the conditions and kept the water cooler for longer. At the end of the lesson, each student wrote a **reflective** paragraph explaining why the final design worked. Maya noticed that many of the adjectives ended in **-ive**. The suffix helped turn familiar base or related words such as act, create, protect, invent and reflect into words that described qualities or tendencies.



Highlight the **-ive** words. Underline a **base or related word** when you can identify one.

4 Word Detective

Choose one **-ive** word from the passage and investigate its structure and meaning.

- Write an **-ive** word from the passage.

- What **base or related word** can you identify?

- What quality or tendency does the word describe?

- Write a word sum or explain any spelling change.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words by what the **-ive** adjective describes.

active

creative

protective

inventive

selective

effective

reflective

responsive

Action / tendency

Quality / function

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

- A protective design should _____

- Use an **-ive** adjective in your own sentence.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises the suffix **-ive**
- ☐ Finds a base or related word
- ☐ Explains the adjective meaning
- ☐ Spells and uses derived words



Capture idea:

Find an **-ive** word in a book, article or information text. Record its base or related word and explain the quality it describes.